

Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...'

Almost Homecoming

LAS CRUCES WILL HAVE more than a casual interest in the El Paso Sun Dodgers this year. In fact Las Cruces may have more interest in the Sun Dodgers than the city will have in a club in New Mexico the Albuquerque Dukes of the Pacific Coast League.

The reason is that Joe Daniels is playing outfield for the Sun Dodgers. Daniels is a Las Cruces youth.

When the Sun Dodgers made their first appearance of the season at Dudley Field Wednesday night, appearing for a workout and a picture posing and interviewing, there were a number of Las Cruces fans in the stands, including Joe Daniels' parents from Las Cruces.

They'll be coming back to El Paso in greater numbers, especially if Joe has a good season.

First Picked by Phils

IT WASN'T DANIELS' first trip to Dudley Field Wednesday night. He had played there as a member of New Mexico University's team against Andy Cohen's U.T. El Paso Miners.

Daniels was first drafted by the Philadelphia Phillies but didn't sign. He had just finished high school and wanted to go to college.

Then he was drafted in his third year at New Mexico by the Los Angeles Dodgers and he accepted their terms.

This will be his third year with the Dodger organization.

In his first year he played in a rookie league at Ogden, Utah, and hit an astounding .359. Last year at Bakersfield in the California League he hit .330. That has earned him a shot with the Sun Dodgers in the Class AA League and who knows but what it will be Albuquerque in the Pacific Coast League next season?

Consistent Man at Bat

APPARENTLY, DANIELS has always been a good hitter. His high school seasons showed .359, .494 and .509 marks and at New Mexico he hit .300 or better in two seasons.

"I think my best batting performance was at Bakersfield last year," said the Las Cruces youth. "I ran a batting streak to 19 games. I had three homeruns in that streak."

Daniels hit 11 homers for the Bakersfield team during the season.

"I'm glad to be able to play in El Paso," said Daniels. "It's really convenient for me because Las Cruces is so close by." There'll be a number of Las Cruces people coming here to see me play. My high school coach said he was going to bring the whole team to a Sun Dodger game."

Daniels rates the Sun Dodgers as a team that should be in the running in the Texas League.

"We have some real fine major league prospects on this team," he said, pointing to Lee Lacy at second base and Jerry Royster at third base.

He didn't say anything about Joe Daniels but he's pretty confident he's going to do well and so apparently is the Dodger organization and Monty Basgall, the Sun Dodger manager.